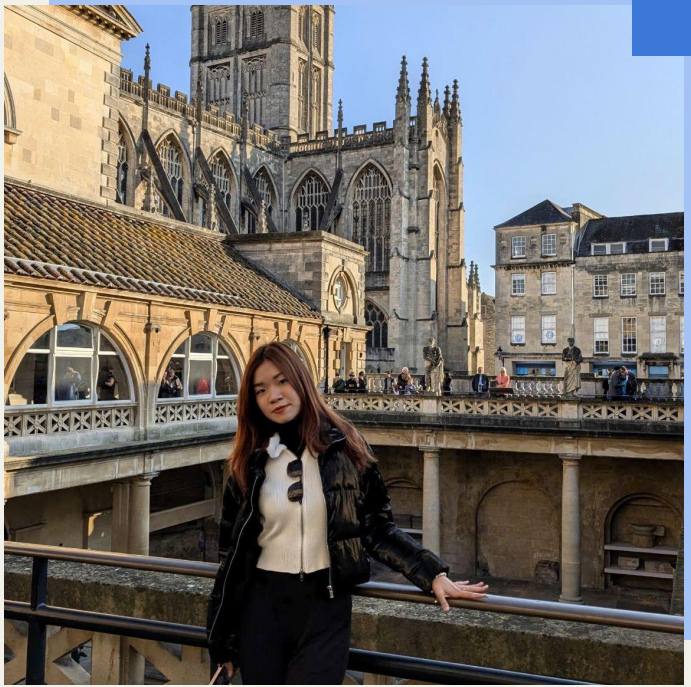
My Vision for Affordable Housing in Illinois: Strategic Insights & Data-Driven Solutions through the IHDA Asset Management Intern Role



ILLINOIS HOUSING DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY

Mai Vy (Valerie) Le

About Me

“Who am I?”

BACKGROUND

Name: Mai Vy (Valerie) Le

Education: Junior at DePauw University (Business Analytics major, Economics & Communications minor)

Professional Experience: Strong background in data analytics, financial analysis, real estate research, and market analytics

Passion Areas: Data-driven decision-making, housing policy, and community development

Objective: Excited about the opportunity to contribute to IHDA’s mission through analytical and strategic insights

Why Housing Matters?

- The Three Basic Human Needs: Food, Shelter, and Clothing
- Illinois: Home to 13 million people (Top 6 states with most people), making housing affordability a major concern
- High rental costs and housing shortages create challenges for families and individuals
- The importance of strategic housing policies in supporting economic growth and sustainability

Why I’m Inspired by IHDA

One of the state’s ten largest financial institutions

Mission-driven approach: Financing the creation and preservation of affordable housing

Impactful initiatives such as the Low-Income Housing Tax Credit (LIHTC), aiming to create over 850 affordable housing units. Commitment to making a real impact in Illinois

Recent projects:

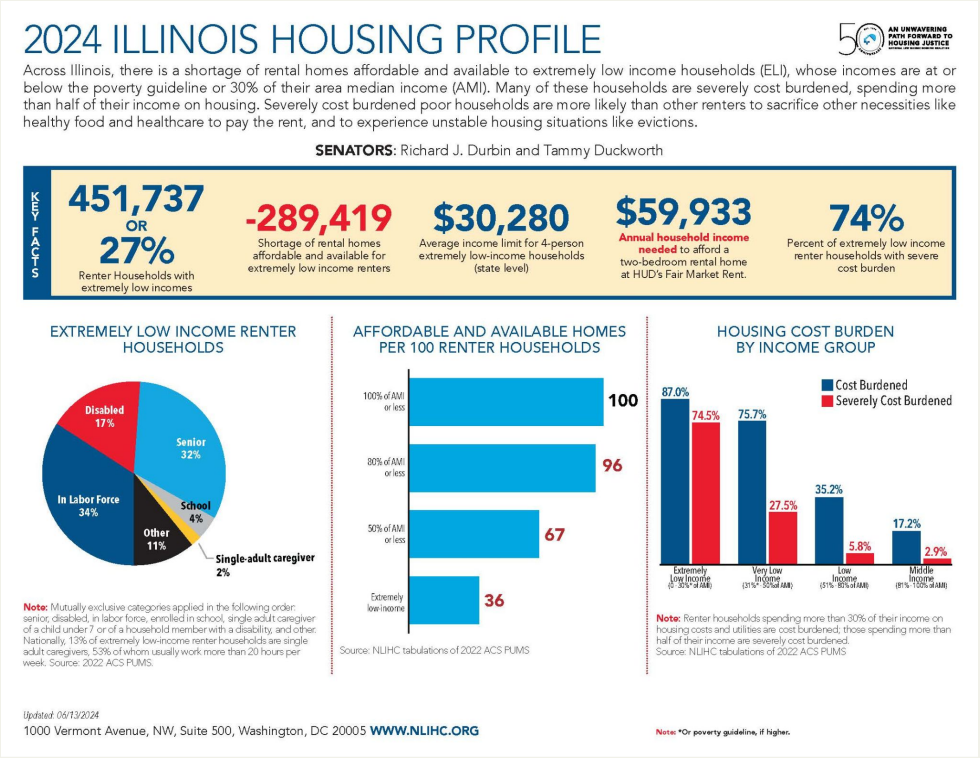
- Garfield School Transformation: Turning historic buildings into senior housing
- Redeveloping shuttered banks in Chicago into affordable housing
- Strong alignment with my skills in financial analysis, finance, data visualization, and strategic research

Understanding Illinois Housing Challenges

Key Statistics:

- 451,737 (27%) of renter households are extremely low-income
- Illinois has a shortage of 289,419 affordable rental homes
- $30,280: Average income limit for a four-person extremely low-income household
- $59,933: Income needed to afford a two-bedroom rental home
- 74% of extremely low-income renter households face severe cost burdens

Alarming fact: Illinois sees one of the nation's most severe income tax increases



2024 ILLINOIS HOUSING PROFILE

AN UNWAVERING PATH FORWARD TO HOUSING JUSTICE

Across Illinois, there is a shortage of rental homes affordable and available to extremely low income households (ELI), whose incomes are at or below the poverty guideline or 30% of their area median income (AMI). Many of these households are severely cost burdened, spending more than half of their income on housing. Severely cost burdened poor households are more likely than other renters to sacrifice other necessities like healthy food and healthcare to pay the rent, and to experience unstable housing situations like evictions.

SENATORS: Richard J. Durbin and Tammy Duckworth

KEY FACTS

451,737 OR **27%** — Renter Households with extremely low incomes

-289,419 — Shortage of rental homes affordable and available for extremely low income renters

$30,280 — Average income limit for 4-person extremely low-income households (state level)

$59,933 — **Annual household income needed** to afford a two-bedroom rental home at HUD's Fair Market Rent.

74% — Percent of extremely low income renter households with severe cost burden

EXTREMELY LOW INCOME RENTER HOUSEHOLDS

Note: Mutually exclusive categories applied in the following order: senior, disabled, in labor force, enrolled in school, single adult caregiver of a child under 7 or of a household member with a disability, and other. Nationally, 13% of extremely low-income renter households are single adult caregivers, 53% of whom usually work more than 20 hours per week. Source: 2022 ACS PUMS.

AFFORDABLE AND AVAILABLE HOMES PER 100 RENTER HOUSEHOLDS

Source: NLIHC tabulations of 2022 ACS PUMS

HOUSING COST BURDEN BY INCOME GROUP

Note: Renter households spending more than 30% of their income on housing costs and utilities are cost burdened; those spending more than half of their income are severely cost burdened.
Source: NLIHC tabulations of 2022 ACS PUMS

Updated: 06/13/2024

1000 Vermont Avenue, NW, Suite 500, Washington, DC 20005 **WWW.NLIHC.ORG**

Note: *Or poverty guideline, if higher.

Source: https://nlihc.org/housing-needs-by-state/illinois

Understanding Illinois Housing Challenges

Alarming fact: Illinois sees one of the nation's most severe income tax increases

How IHDA plays a crucial role in addressing these challenges

- Affordable Housing Development: Funds tax credits and financing programs to build and rehab affordable rental units. Programs like the Affordable Housing Tax Credit and Multifamily Financing Programs

- Rental Assistance: Provides subsidies to low-income households to bridge the rent gap.

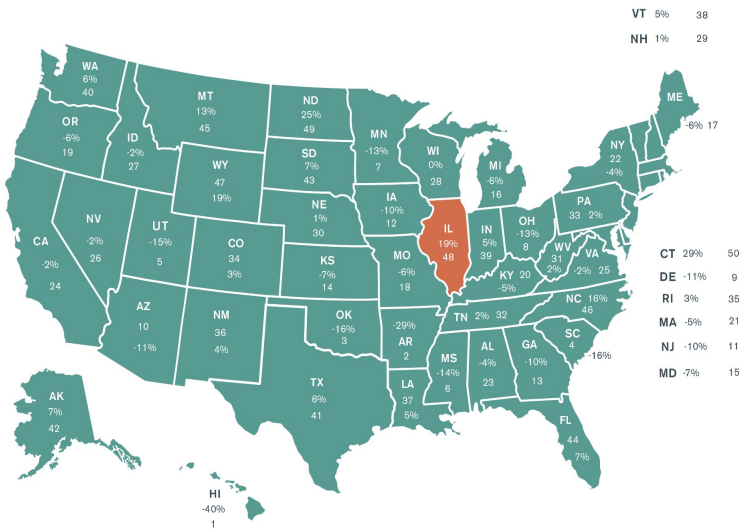
- Homeownership Support: Offers down payment and loan assistance for renters transitioning to homeownership.

- Community Revitalization: Invests in vacant properties to stabilize neighborhoods.

- Supportive Housing: Funds housing for vulnerable populations, including those with special needs and justice-involved individuals. Programs like Permanent Supportive Housing and Housing for Justice Involved Individuals (HJIIP)

Illinois sees one of the nation's most severe income tax increases

Ranking, percentage change in the effective income tax rate, 2002-2004 to 2013-2015 (1=largest decrease, 50=largest increase)



Note: Illinois' income tax was 5 percent in 2013-2015, while it is 4.95 percent today

Source: U.S. Census Bureau American Community Survey

Source: https://www.illinoispolicy.org/reports/house-hunters-how-high-taxes-hurt-home-investment-in-illinois/ | https://www.ihda.org/

My Previous Experiences

“What I Bring to the Table”

PREVIOUS EXPERIENCES

- HP Tech Ventures: Conducted startup sourcing and investment analysis using platforms like Crunchbase and PitchBook, identifying high-potential opportunities aligned with strategic investment theses.
- 1st Source Bank: Utilized marketing analytics and regression analysis to assess customer satisfaction, optimize campaigns, and generate Power BI reports on customer behavior trends and segmentations.
- Hub of China: Led market research and data analysis on global consumer trends, delivering insights that improved client strategies for entering the Chinese market.
- WWF: Enhanced reporting processes and data accessibility for over 20 teams, streamlining knowledge sharing and improving conservation impact assessments.
- Skills: Proficient in Power BI, Tableau, Google Analytics, Python, SQL, and Microsoft Office Suite, with expertise in investment analysis, customer segmentation, regression analysis, and data visualization.

How I Stand Out?

Empathy & Understanding of Customers

- As an international student, I personally relate to the struggles of finding affordable housing

- Strong ability to connect with diverse communities and understand their financial constraints

Collaboration & Communication

- Worked with cross-functional teams to develop actionable recommendations
- Ability to convey complex information in a meaningful way

Passion for Real Estate & Housing Policy

- Continuously researching and staying up to date with trends
- Understanding the significance of sustainable housing solutions

How I Can Help IHDA & Illinois? Let’s drive growth together!

- **Data-Driven Decision-Making:** Leveraging tools like Power BI, Tableau, and MySQL to analyze market trends and inform policy changes
- **Process Improvement:** Identifying opportunities for streamlining operations, enhancing digital tools, and optimizing compliance strategies
- **Affordable Housing Advocacy:** Researching and recommending policies that enhance housing access for low-income and immigrant communities
- **Strategic Resource Allocation:** Utilizing data analytics to optimize funding distribution and maximize the impact of IHDA’s housing programs across Illinois.

Innovative Ideas for IHDA

- **Adaptive Reuse Projects:** Transforming underutilized spaces into affordable housing

- **Tech Integration:**

  Developing data dashboards for better tracking of affordable housing needs

- **Policy Enhancement:**

  Exploring solutions like tax incentives for sustainable housing projects

Let’s Build a Better Illinois Housing Community Together

My vision: A future where every Illinois resident has access to safe and affordable housing

My commitment: Bringing data-driven insights and strategic solutions to IHDA

Next steps: Excited to discuss how I can contribute to your team and mission!

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